

MI Skill Code — Clinician Self-Rating Form

Motivational Interviewing Fidelity Assessment · Adapted from MISC 2.0

Purpose

Use this tool after session to reflect on your MI adherence and skill. Research shows that self-coding against defined behavioral anchors accelerates MI skill acquisition faster than general reflection. Complete immediately after the session while the interaction is fresh.

Clinician: _____ Date: _____ Session #: _____ Client ID: _____

Part 1 — Spirit of MI

Rate the overall quality of the spirit you brought to this session (circle one number):

MI Spirit Element	Description	Rating (1-5)
Partnership	I approached the client as an equal partner, not an expert directing them.	1 2 3 4 5
Acceptance	I communicated unconditional positive regard and accurate empathy.	1 2 3 4 5
Autonomy Support	I affirmed the client's right and capacity to make their own decisions.	1 2 3 4 5
Evocation	I actively drew out the client's own reasons for change rather than supplying them.	1 2 3 4 5
Compassion	My primary concern was genuinely the client's wellbeing.	1 2 3 4 5

Part 2 — OARS Microskill Frequency

Estimate how frequently you used each skill during this session:

Skill	Description	Count (estimate)	Quality (1-5)
Open Questions	Cannot be answered yes/no; invite elaboration	_____	1 2 3 4 5
Closed Questions	Yes/no or limited response; note if excessive	_____	n/a
Simple Reflections	Repeating or slightly rephrasing what client said	_____	1 2 3 4 5

Complex Reflections	Adding meaning, emotion, or continuing the paragraph	_____	1 2 3 4 5
Affirmations	Genuine recognition of strengths, efforts, or worth	_____	1 2 3 4 5
Summaries	Collecting and reflecting back multiple client statements	_____	1 2 3 4 5
MI-Adherent Advice	Information/advice given only with permission	_____	1 2 3 4 5
MI-Non-Adherent	Unsolicited advice, arguing, confronting, warning	_____	—

Evidence-Based Targets (Miller & Rollnick)

Target Reflection:Question ratio = at least 2:1. Complex reflections should be at least 40% of all reflections. MI-Non-Adherent responses should be 0.

Part 3 — Change Talk & Sustain Talk

Change Talk Type (DARN-C)	Examples Heard in Session
Desire ('I want to...')	
Ability ('I could...')	
Reasons ('It would help because...')	
Need ('I have to...')	
Commitment ('I will...')	
Taking Steps ('I've started...')	
Sustain Talk heard (note themes):	

Reflection & Goals for Next Session

One specific MI skill I will strengthen in my next session:
